

- [TradePilot – Why We’re Losing Now: Apr → Jul Degradation Analysis](#)
- [1. The verdict up front](#)
- [2. The degradation table – v5 \(live\)](#)
- [3. The degradation table – v5_classic \(frozen original\)](#)
- [4. The core finding – the win rate IS the story](#)
- [5. Why the win rate collapsed \(the complexity cascade\)](#)
- [6. The capital-efficiency reality – the ₹1-2k problem](#)
- [7. All present engines \(since 06-15\)](#)
- [8. The path back – revert, don’t reinvent](#)

TradePilot – Why We’re Losing Now: Apr → Jul Degradation Analysis

Full historical comparison (10 Apr → 6 Jul). How we traded then vs now – trades, timing, win-rate, deployment, and return-on-capital – and why ₹1-2k on ₹10L means the current engine is broken, not the concept.

Project	TradePilot (NSE intraday, paper)
Window	2026-04-10 → 2026-07-06
Capital	₹10,00,000 per engine
Full-history engines	v5 (live), v5_classic (frozen original)
Question	Why are we losing badly now, and why can’t we make real money on ₹10L even on green days?
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1. The verdict up front

You are right that the current engine is badly designed – but the data proves a well-designed one makes real money on ₹10L, because we *had* one in April. In April, live v5 returned **+1.35%/day (₹13,547) at a 77% win rate**. By July it returns **–0.24%/day at 46%**. This is not a concept that can’t work; it’s a **monotonic degradation** of a proven engine. The ₹1-2k days that frustrate you are the *symptom*: a 46%-win-rate coin-flip deploying capital into a book that fights the market. The fix is to **revert to the April design**, not reinvent it.

2. The degradation table – v5 (live)

MONTH	DAYS	AVG P&L	RETURN/ DAY	TRADES/ DAY	WIN%	AVG ENTRY	AVG HOLD	DEPLOY%
April	14	+₹13,547	+1.35%	60	77%	11:08	73m	94%
May	17	+₹2,725	+0.27%	51	53%	11:46	97m	61%
June	19	−₹220	−0.02%	52	48%	11:31	118m	68%
July	2	−₹2,408	−0.24%	73	46%	11:26	84m	101%

3. The degradation table – v5_classic (frozen original)

MONTH	DAYS	AVG P&L	RETURN/ DAY	TRADES/ DAY	WIN%	AVG ENTRY	AVG HOLD	DEPLOY%
April	9	+₹4,361	+0.44%	53	66%	10:52	86m	68%
May	17	+₹3,510	+0.35%	47	52%	11:24	109m	61%
June	18	+₹596	+0.06%	47	50%	11:00	139m	64%
July	2	−₹1,060	−0.11%	62	43%	10:50	104m	74%

v5_classic degraded too, but far more gently (66%→43% WR vs v5's 77%→46%; still +0.06% in June while v5 was −0.02%). It carries *none* of the rebuild's later additions – which is exactly why it decayed slower. It's the closest thing we have to the April engine still running.

4. The core finding – the win rate IS the story

METRIC	APRIL	JULY	CHANGE
Win rate (v5)	77%	46%	−31 points – from selective to coin-flip
Return/day (v5)	+1.35%	−0.24%	from +₹13.5k to losing
Trades/day	60	73	more churn
Avg hold	73m	84-118m	holding losers longer

Everything traces to the **win-rate collapse from 77% to 46%**. At 77% with a tight bracket, the math prints money; at 46% it bleeds. Nothing else – trade count, deployment, entry time – moved enough to explain the swing. The engine stopped *picking well*.

5. Why the win rate collapsed (the complexity cascade)

The 77%-WR April engine was: **NIFTY-50, top-5, long-only, tight +1.5/-0.75 bracket, early entry, flat by EOD**. Everything added since diluted it:

CHANGE ADDED	EFFECT ON WIN RATE
Short book	Shorts bleed on green days AND sideways chop (verified: shorts – ₹3,611 net over 06-16..25; both green days 07-01/07-02 shorts red)
Universe 50 → 200	4x more marginal names → lower average conviction
Late entry (rescore loop)	Avg entry ~11:00-11:46 (should be ~09:20); winners become stops
Longer holds (73m → 118m)	Holding losers hoping for reversal instead of clean bracket exits
Overfit 1,735-tree ML	Memorized noise; a 5-tree model out-hits it
Churn (57 trades/day)	Short-then-long the same name (DABUR 07-01: shorted –₹756 AND longed –₹217)

6. The capital-efficiency reality – the ₹1-2k problem

SCENARIO	DAILY	MONTHLY (~20 DAYS)	ON ₹10L
April v5 (proven)	+₹13,547	~₹2.7 lakh	+27%/month
Current v5 (July)	–₹2,408	~–₹48k	losing
A "good" current day	+₹1-5k	–	+0.1-0.5%

This is the heart of your frustration, quantified. A +₹2k day on ₹10L is **+0.2%** – trivial. But April shows ₹10L *can* yield **+1.35%/day** with the same capital. The gap isn't the capital or the concept – it's the **31 points of lost win rate**. The current engine under-uses a proven edge: it deploys the money, then picks at 46% and shorts into strength.

7. All present engines (since 06-15)

ENGINE	DAYS	AVG P&L/DAY	RETURN/DAY	WIN%	CUMULATIVE
v5 (live)	14	–₹687	–0.07%	46%	–₹9,614
v5_classic (frozen)	14	+₹497	+0.05%	49%	+₹6,960
v5_long	4	–₹968	–0.10%	51%	–₹3,872
v5_cut	9	+₹576	+0.06%	47%	+₹5,185
v5_flip	2	–₹586	–0.06%	52%	–₹1,173

Only **v5_classic** (the frozen original) and **v5_cut** (tighter short-gate) are positive. **Live v5 is the worst (–₹9,614)**. The two winners are the two engines closest to “clean execution + disciplined shorts” – the April recipe. The message is consistent across every cut of the data.

8. The path back – revert, don’t reinvent

The April engine is the target and the blueprint. Ranked:

1. **Restore clean early-entry execution** (kill the rescore-loop late entry; enter ~09:20 and hold to bracket). v5_classic already does this and decayed least.
2. **Suppress shorts on green / regime-tilt** (the short book is the biggest single win-rate drag; v5_cut’s tighter short-gate + a BULL-side tilt).
3. **Concentrate + fully deploy ₹10L** into fewer, higher-conviction names (April ran 94% deployed at 77% WR; stop fragmenting into 45 marginal trades).
4. **Shrink the ML model** (5-tree beats 1,735-tree) or keep it at weight 0.

Target to hold ourselves to: not “a green day, ±₹1–2k.” The bar is April – **+1% day / 65%+ win rate / ₹10L working**. The proof it’s reachable is in our own April data.